

APEX GLOBAL TECHNOLOGIES INC.

IT & CYBERSECURITY HANDBOOK

Information Security, Asset Usage, Data Protection, and Incident Response

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Target Audience	All Enterprise Network Users

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1.0 Cybersecurity Architecture Overview

Apex Global Technologies enforces a strict Zero Trust Security Architecture. Security is a shared responsibility across all employees.

2.0 Access Control, MFA & Password Policy

Authentication mechanisms protect enterprise systems against unauthorized access.

2.1 Password Requirements

- Minimum length of 16 characters including uppercase, numbers, and symbols.
- Mandatory rotation every 90 days.
- Use of corporate enterprise password managers (Bitwarden / 1Password) is required.

2.2 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA is mandatory across all enterprise portals. Hardware security keys or authenticator apps must be used. SMS-based MFA is prohibited.

3.0 Workstation Security & Hardware Asset Rules

Company-provided laptops and hardware remain the property of Apex Global Technologies.

3.1 Device Safeguards

Laptops must be locked (Win+L / Cmd+Ctrl+Q) whenever stepping away. Unattended devices in public areas or personal cars are strictly forbidden.

3.2 Local Administrator Rights

Standard users are not granted local administrator rights. All software installation must be deployed via the IT Software Center.

4.0 Data Classification & Encryption

Enterprise data is classified into 4 tiers to determine security handling requirements.

Tier	Classification Level	Handling & Storage Rules
Tier 1	Public	Approved for general distribution
Tier 2	Internal Operations	Internal access only (OneDrive / SharePoint)
Tier 3	Confidential Client Data	Restricted access; AES-256 encrypted
Tier 4	Restricted (PII / Secrets)	Strict role-based access; zero local download

5.0 Acceptable Network & Internet Usage

Enterprise network connections are continuously monitored to protect against cyber threats.

5.1 Prohibited Network Activities

- Accessing torrent networks or unauthorized file sharing.
- Connecting unauthorized Wi-Fi routers or network hardware to office ports.
- Hosting personal web servers on company infrastructure.

6.0 Email Security & Phishing Awareness

Email remains the primary attack vector for enterprise cyber incidents.

Phishing Protocol: Do not click untrusted links or open unexpected attachments. Use the "Report Phishing" button in Outlook immediately upon receiving suspicious mail.

7.0 Remote Access & VPN Governance

Remote connections to corporate networks must be routed through the Always-On Enterprise VPN.

7.1 Public Wi-Fi Security

Connecting to unencrypted public Wi-Fi networks (airports, cafes) without active enterprise VPN encryption is strictly prohibited.

8.0 Incident Management & Security Escalation

Rapid reporting mitigates security threats and safeguards enterprise data.

8.1 Mandatory 1-Hour Security Incident Reporting

Lost laptops, compromised passwords, or suspected malware infections must be reported to the IT Security Hotline within 1 hour of occurrence.

9.0 Security Compliance & User Security Pledge

Failure to adhere to IT security policies may result in access revocation, disciplinary action, or employment termination.

Security Acknowledgement

I agree to adhere to all security controls, asset guidelines, and data protection rules in the IT Handbook.

User Signature: _____

Date: _____